PRODUCT OVERVIEW

October 2026



On the Horizon

Money as light. Goal-based saving, told in images.

React · Tailwind · Vite · localStorage

01 — THE IDEA

Savings you can see

Most savings apps show a number and a progress bar. On the Horizon shows the thing you are saving for, and lets it come into focus as you fund it. The goal image is the progress bar: dark, blurred and colourless at 0%, sharp and vivid at 100%.

The image is the metric

Progress is felt before it is read. A glance at the gallery tells you which dreams are close and which are still out of focus.

No financial jargon

No yield tables or transaction logs. One goal, one price, one plan in plain days.

Time is part of the story

Prices rise while you wait. The photo can drift back out of focus when you stop saving, which makes the cost of waiting visible.

Purpose in one sentence

Help people stay motivated to save by turning abstract money into a visible, emotionally meaningful picture of the life they are funding, and by showing honestly how long it will take.

Who it is for

People who find budgeting apps cold or overwhelming: first-time savers, anyone saving toward a specific experience (a trip, a wedding, a first car), and users who respond better to visuals than to spreadsheets.

A different way to show progress

	Typical savings app	On the Horizon
What you see	Balances, percentages and charts	The goal itself, out of focus or sharp
How it feels	Tracking and obligation	Anticipation and reward
Effort to read	Needs interpretation	Understood at a glance
Setup	Accounts, categories, rules	A name, a price, a photo and a plan in days
Time	Ignored	Prices rise, so waiting has a visible cost

02 — THE CORE MECHANIC

Money as light

Every goal has a price today and an amount saved. The percentage between them is the only number the visual layer needs. It maps straight onto two CSS filters, so the picture updates in real time whenever a deposit is added.

```
percentage = saved / priceToday * 100 (clamped 0 to 100)
blurValue = 25px - (percentage * 0.25)
grayscaleValue = 100% - percentage

filter: `blur(${blurValue}px)
grayscale(${grayscaleValue}%)`
```



0%
blur 25px
grayscale 100%

25%
blur 18.75px
grayscale 75%

50%
blur 12.5px
grayscale 50%

75%
blur 6.25px
grayscale 25%

100%
blur 0px
grayscale 0%

The same image at five stages of funding. Illustrative scene; in the app each card uses the photo the user uploaded.

Linear and predictable

Both filters are straight-line functions of progress, so there are no thresholds to tune.

Derived, not stored

Blur and grayscale are never saved. Only deposits and price settings are stored; the look is recomputed on every render.

The price moves too

priceToday rises with time, so without new deposits the percentage slowly falls and the photo drifts out of focus.

03 — USER INTERACTION

From first goal to full colour

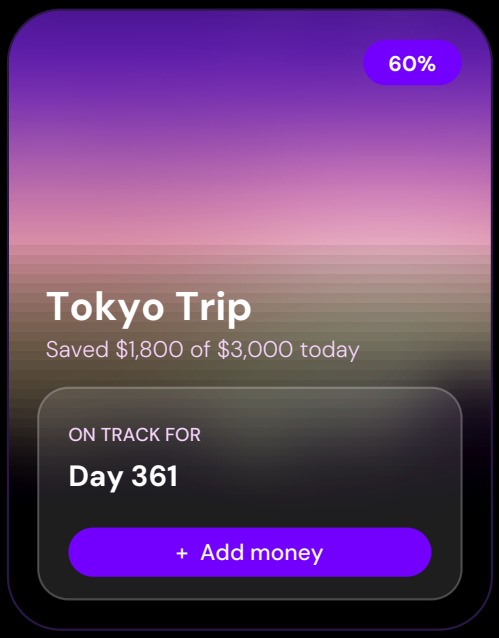
A gallery of goals, a goal detail screen and two bottom sheets: one to create a goal and one to add money.

1. **Open the dashboard**
   A dark gallery shows every goal as a photo card with a percentage chip, saved against today's price, and an Add money button.

2. **Create a goal**
   Name, price today, an uploaded photo and the expected yearly price increase. Then a plan in days: save a fixed amount per day, week or month, or reach it in N days (30, 90, 180, 365 or custom).

3. **Add money**
   A bottom sheet takes an amount and a date. Each deposit joins a history, and withdrawals are allowed. The photo sharpens smoothly.

4. **Read the plan**
   The detail screen says in plain words when the goal will be reached and what it will cost then, with previews of the user's own photo at today, plus 6 months and plus 1 year.



Design language

The interface follows a dark, premium style: black backgrounds, an electric violet accent for active states and buttons, soft lilac for chips and highlights, heavy rounding on cards and buttons, and DM Sans throughout. The eight-point star is the brand mark and doubles as the symbol for light.

Black #000000
Base background

Violet #7300FF
Primary accent

Lilac #F8D4FD
Chips, highlights

White #FFFFFF
Text

04 — THE MATHS

Time changes the price

Goals are rarely bought on the day they are created. The app projects the price forward with a simple yearly increase, so every plan accounts for what waiting costs.

Symbol	Meaning	Example
P0	Price of the goal on the day it was created	$3,000
g	Expected yearly price increase, set per goal (6% is a placeholder default)	6% (0.06)
d	Days since the goal was created, or days into the future for a projection	0 to 7,300
S	Amount saved: deposits minus withdrawals, never below zero	$600

Price on day d (compounds yearly)

```
priceAt(d) = P0 * (1 + g) ^ (d / 365)
```

Progress used by the image

```
percentage = S / priceAt(daysElapsed) * 100
```

Cost of waiting

```
costOfWaiting(d) = priceAt(d) - priceToday
```

Worked example: Tokyo Trip, P0 = $3,000, g = 6%

Day	Calculation	Price	Cost of waiting
182	3000 * 1.06 ^ (182 / 365)	$3,088.44	$88.44
365	3000 * 1.06 ^ 1	$3,180.00	$180.00
730	3000 * 1.06 ^ 2	$3,370.80	$370.80

Why compounding

After two years the increase is $370.80, not $360. Year two grows on the higher year-one price.

About the 6%

It is an editable placeholder. Real price growth differs by country and by what is being bought, so each goal has its own field and defaults can vary by currency.

All projections are estimates. Real prices may differ.

05 — PLANNING MODES

Two ways to plan, both in days

The user either says how much they can save, or when they want the goal. The app answers the other half of the question.

A. Save a fixed amount

perDay = amount / 1, 7 or 30.44

```
Find the first day d where
S + perDay * d >= priceAt(d)
```

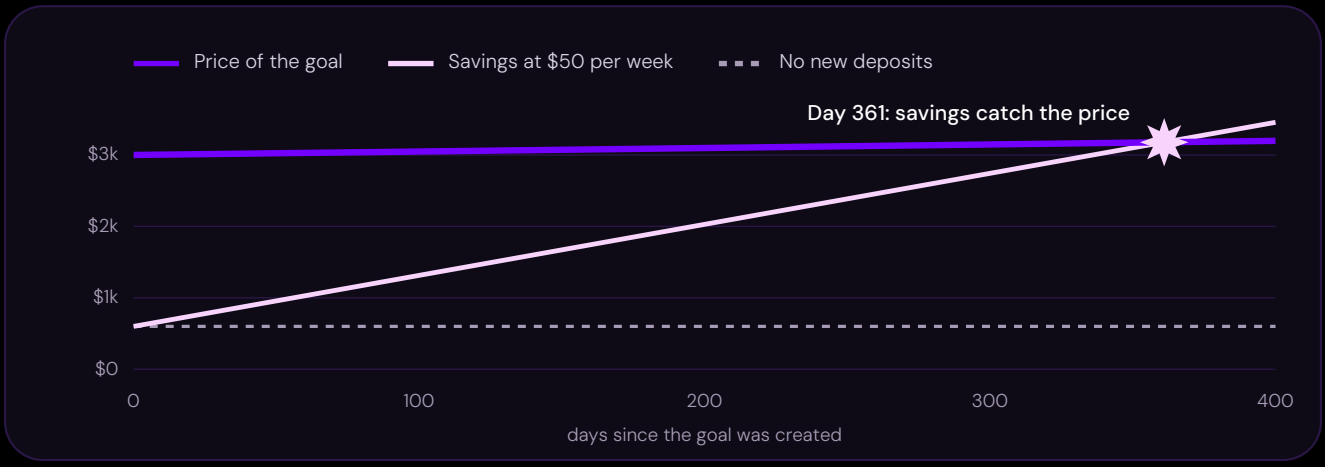
If it never happens within 7,300 days, the app says the price is growing faster than the savings.

B. Reach it in N days

```
needed = priceAt(N) - S
perDay = needed / N
perWeek = perDay * 7
perMonth = perDay * 30.44
```

Same example, with $600 already saved

Plan	Result
A. $50 per week (= $7.14 per day)	Reached on day 361, about 12 months. Price then: $3,178, which is $178 more than today.
B. Reach it in 365 days	Needs $2,580 more: $7.07 per day, $49.48 per week or $215.16 per month.
A. Only $10 per week	Reached after about 2,936 days, close to 8 years. Small amounts barely outrun the price.



Future you: the same photo at three points, plan A with $50 per week

Day	Price	Saved	Clarity	Blur / grayscale	No deposits
0	$3,000.00	$600.00	20%	20px / 80%	20%
182	$3,088.44	$1,900.00	61.5%	9.6px / 38.5%	19.4%
365	$3,180.00	$3,207.14	100%	0px / 0%	18.9%

06 — TECHNOLOGY

A lean, single-night stack

On the Horizon is a front-end only single-page app. There is no server and no database, which keeps the build small and fast to iterate on.

Layer	Choice	Role in the app
UI framework	React	Component model for the gallery, goal cards, detail screen and sheets; state drives every render.
Styling	Tailwind CSS	Utility classes for the dark theme, rounded cards, glassmorphism and responsive grid.
Build tool	Vite	Fast dev server and production bundling for the single-page app.
Persistence	localStorage	Goals, deposits and plan settings saved on a short debounce. No backend required.
Maths	utils/projection.js	Pure functions for days elapsed, price projection and plan results. Easy to unit test.
Visual engine	CSS filters	blur() and grayscale() applied as inline styles from the progress percentage.
Image handling	Canvas API	Uploaded photos are resized and compressed in the browser, then saved as base64 JPEG.
Typography	DM Sans	Weights 300 to 700, loaded from Google Fonts.

Data flow

```
add deposit > goal.deposits updated in React state > saved, price and percentage recomputed
> inline filter re-renders > debounced write to localStorage
```

Illustrative goal object

```
{ id, name: "Tokyo Trip", basePrice: 3000, yearlyIncrease: 6, priceDrift: true,
createdAt: "2026-10-10", image: "...",
deposits: [ { id, amount: 600, date: "2026-10-10", type: "add" } ],
plan: { mode: "fixed", amount: 50, period: "week" } }
```

Why it works

Everything on screen is a pure function of stored amounts and dates, so the UI stays in sync with no extra plumbing.

Photo storage budget

localStorage holds about 5 MB. Photos are scaled to about 900px on the long side and saved as JPEG at 80% quality. Writes are debounced, not made on every keystroke.

07 — FINTECH CONTEXT

Where it fits in fintech

On the Horizon sits in the personal finance and goal-based saving category. It works on the engagement layer, the part of a financial product that decides whether people actually keep saving.

Goal-based saving

Money is labelled by purpose (Tokyo Trip, not Savings 2). Naming a goal makes the money feel earmarked and harder to spend elsewhere.

Behavioural finance

People tend to put in more effort as a goal gets closer, and a concrete picture of a future outcome makes it easier to prioritise. Price drift adds gentle urgency: waiting visibly costs more.

Low barrier to entry

Plain visuals and plans in days lower the barrier for people who are put off by charts, rates and jargon.

What it is today, and what it is not

Today (prototype)	Not yet
Tracks deposits the user logs by hand and projects future prices.	Does not hold, move or invest money.
Stores goals and photos only in the browser; nothing is sent to a server.	No accounts, sync across devices or server-side security.
Focuses on motivation, planning and visual feedback.	No regulated financial activity, so no custody, advice or payments.

Possible next steps toward a full fintech product

Step	What it adds
Account linking	Read deposits from a bank account or savings pot so history fills in automatically instead of by hand.
Automated contributions	Recurring transfers or round-ups that move real money into a goal, sharpening the image over time.
Accounts and sync	Sign-in and a backend so goals and photos persist across devices, and images move out of the 5 MB browser limit.
Milestones and access	Notifications at 25, 50 and 75%, a celebration at 100%, and a toggle that shows exact amounts beside the image so progress never depends on sight alone.
Smarter price estimates	Default yearly increase by currency or goal type, from official statistics, instead of one flat placeholder.

Any step involving real money would require a licensed partner (such as a bank or payments provider) and local regulatory review.